

CHARACTER CASE STUDY

Understanding the Character In & Out

Character: ____

Movie/Story: ____

Age: _

Occupation: ____

PART 1 — THE PERSON OUTSIDE THE STORY

Before analysing the plot, imagine this person has a life beyond the movie.

1. Basic Life

Where do they live?

What does a normal day look like?

What do they do when nobody is watching?

What do they enjoy?

What irritates them?

What are they naturally good at?

What are they bad at?

2. Their History

What was their childhood like?

Who raised them?

Who influenced them the most?

What is one event that changed them?

What is something they lost?

What is something they never received?

PART 2 — THE HUMAN BEING INSIDE

Don't ask what the character *should* feel.

Ask what **this particular person would actually feel**.

3. Emotional Map

What makes them genuinely happy?

What makes them angry?

What embarrasses them?

What makes them feel powerless?

What scares them?

What makes them jealous?

What makes them feel loved?

What makes them feel rejected?

What makes them feel guilty?

4. The Hidden Emotion

What emotion do they show most often?

What emotion do they actually carry underneath?

Example:

Outside: Anger

Inside: Fear of being abandoned

Now do yours:

Outside: __

Inside: ____

PART 3 — WHAT THEY WANT VS WHAT THEY NEED

5. External Want

What does the character consciously want?

"I want ____."

What will they do to get it?

What are they willing to sacrifice?

What are they NOT willing to sacrifice?

6. Emotional Need

What does this person actually need emotionally?

"Deep down, I need ____."

But why can't they simply accept that need?

What are they afraid will happen if they admit it?

PART 4 — THE WOUND

7. What Hurt Them?

What past experience still affects their behaviour?

What did they learn from that experience?

What conclusion did they make about life?

"Because __ happened, I believe ____."

Is that belief actually true?

PART 5 — THEIR WORLDVIEW

8. Core Beliefs

Complete these:

"People are..."

"Love is..."

"Power is..."

"Weakness is..."

"Family is..."

"Failure means..."

"I am..."

9. The Lie They Believe

What does the character believe about themselves or the world that isn't completely true?

"If I ____, then ____."

What painful truth are they avoiding?

PART 6 — CONTRADICTION

This is extremely important for creating believable characters.

10. Find Their Opposites

They say: ____

But they do: ____

They want: ____

But they fear: _____

They appear: ____

But internally: ____

They hate: ____

But secretly enjoy: ____

They value: ____

But sometimes violate: ____

11. The Character's Hypocrisy

What standard do they expect from others but fail to follow themselves?

What would they criticize another person for doing?

Have they ever done the same thing?

PART 7 — RELATIONSHIPS

Characters reveal themselves differently with different people.

12. Character A

Who is the person they are closest to?

How do they behave around them?

What do they want from this person?

What are they afraid of losing?

What can they say to this person that they can't say to anyone else?

13. Character B

Who challenges them?

Why does this person irritate them?

What does this person understand about them?

What truth does this person force them to confront?

14. Character Mask

How does the character behave with:

Strangers: _____

Friends: ____

Family: ____

Enemy: ____

Person they love: _____

When completely alone: __

PART 8 — BEHAVIOUR

Don't describe the character with adjectives.

Study what they **actually do**.

15. Under Pressure

When scared, they:

When angry, they:

When jealous, they:

When rejected, they:

When someone loves them, they:

When they feel guilty, they:

When they lose control, they:

16. The Small Behaviour

Find 3 tiny behaviours that reveal the character.

1.

2.

3.

Examples:

- Avoids eye contact when lying.
- Laughs when uncomfortable.
- Checks their phone after an argument.
- Becomes unusually quiet when hurt.

Small behaviour often creates more believable drama than big dialogue.

PART 9 — THE SECRET

17. What Don't They Tell Anyone?

What is the one thing they don't want people to know?

Why don't they reveal it?

Who would they hate to find out?

What would happen if it were exposed?

18. What Do They Lie About?

What do they lie about to others?

What do they lie about to themselves?

The second one is usually more important.

PART 10 — PRESSURE TEST

Now stop analysing.

Put the character under pressure.

Scenario 1 — They Lose Something Important

What do they do?

What do they say?

What do they secretly feel?

Scenario 2 — Someone Betrays Them

Their first reaction:

What they show:

What they actually feel:

What they want to do:

What stops them:

Scenario 3 — They Must Choose

Option A: Get what they want but hurt someone they love.

Option B: Protect the person but lose what they want.

Which do they choose?

Why?

PART 11 — THE BREAKING POINT

This is where drama begins.

19. What Can They Tolerate?

They can tolerate:

20. What Can They NOT Tolerate?

21. What Would Make Them Finally Break?

What would their breaking point look like?

Would they:

Run / Fight / Lie / Confess / Betray / Forgive / Destroy / Sacrifice / Give up

Why?

PART 12 — CHARACTER ARC

Beginning

Who are they emotionally?

What do they believe?

What are they avoiding?

Middle

What forces them to question themselves?

What becomes impossible to ignore?

Breaking Point

What truth finally becomes unavoidable?

Ending

What do they finally understand?

What changes?

What remains unchanged?

PART 13 — THE DRAMA ENGINE

Complete this sentence:

My character wants __, but __ prevents them from getting it.

The worst thing that could happen to them is ____.

They are forced to choose between __ and ____.

If they choose what they want, they will lose ____.

If they choose what they need, they must give up ____.

PART 14 — THE "FEEL THE CHARACTER" TEST

Close the worksheet.

Forget all the answers.

Imagine you ARE this character.

Someone you desperately love says:

"I don't need you anymore."

What is your **first thought**?

What is your **first physical reaction**?

What would you say?

What would you WANT to say but hide?

What would you do after they leave?

Now ask:

"Why did I react that way?"

Keep asking **"Why?"** until you reach something emotionally painful.

FINAL CHARACTER SNAPSHOT

Complete this without thinking too much.

This person wants:

Because:

But they fear:

Because of:

So they pretend:

But secretly they need:

Their biggest contradiction is:

The person who understands them best is:

The thing that can break them is:

The truth they don't want to accept is:

Their biggest emotional choice is:

THE ONE-SENTENCE HUMAN BEING

Don't write their plot.

Don't write their occupation.

Don't write their goal.

Describe the **human being**.

"This is a person who ____ *because* ____ and secretly fears ____."
